

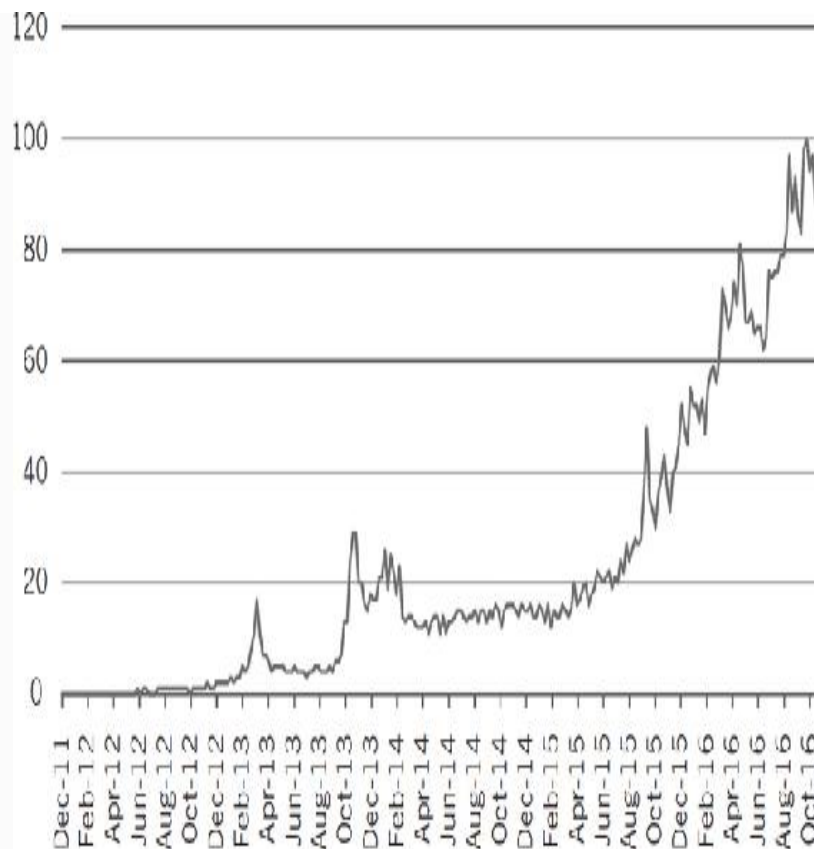


Figure 3.2 ■ The rise in Google Search trends for the term “blockchain” Data sourced from Google Search Trends

Masters’s focus for blockchain technology in financial services is on private blockchains, which are very different from Bitcoin’s blockchain. Pivotal to the current conversation, private blockchains don’t need native assets. Since access to the network is tightly controlled—largely maintaining security through exclusivity—the role of computers supporting the blockchain is different.¹⁵ Since these computers don’t have to worry about attack from the outside—they are operating behind a firewall and collaborating with known entities—it removes the need for a native asset that incentivizes the build-out of a robust network of miners.